

SOCIAL CONTRACT TRUNCATED

ERBIUM INDUSTRIES – SOCIAL CONTRACT

This document establishes the expectations and boundaries for **Erbium Industries**. It may be revisited if the needs of the campaign or table change.

CAMPAIGN EXPECTATIONS

Erbium Industries is a grounded science-fiction campaign about people trying to survive and decide what they are willing to do along the way.

The setting includes dangerous labor, corporate exploitation, debt, coercive employment, surveillance, discrimination, denial of legal personhood, bodily control, religion, politics, violence, and death. It will also include humor, friendship, exploration, wonder, downtime, victories, and meaningful relationships.

Players should create characters who can participate in the premise and continue traveling with the party. Characters may disagree, argue, dislike one another, and make poor decisions, but those conflicts must still allow the players to participate together.

Players are not expected to make the most tactically optimal, morally perfect, or narratively convenient decisions.

MORALITY

The campaign uses **Catholic moral teaching** as its standard for questions of good, evil, moral responsibility, and the consequences of human action.

The campaign focuses on **temporal consequences**: the damage wrongdoing causes to people, relationships, communities, the person committing the act, and the world around them.

God will not be portrayed as directly intervening, and the GM will not speak for God. Religious characters may believe, doubt, interpret events, or attribute meaning to their experiences, but purported divine responses will remain ambiguous or absent.

PLAYER CHARACTERS

Evil player characters are not permitted.

Characters may be flawed and may occasionally commit genuinely evil acts. Such acts should remain exceptional and will carry appropriate consequences.

A character who develops a sustained pattern of knowingly committing serious evil will require a meaningful course correction or retirement from play.

Characters remain morally responsible for their choices even when the laws or institutions of the Settled Systems permit injustice. Knowledge, intention, freedom, pressure, and circumstances may affect that responsibility.

When a moral question materially affects GM adjudication, Catholic moral teaching will provide the standard.

CONTENT BOUNDARIES

A player may establish a boundary at any point during the campaign.

Anyone may ask for a scene to stop, change, receive less description, or fade to black. The request will be respected in the moment, and nobody is required to justify why particular material makes them uncomfortable.

If a new boundary substantially conflicts with a central premise of the campaign, the GM and player will discuss whether it can reasonably be accommodated.

LINES

A **Line** is material that will not appear in the campaign.

Lines:

- ◆ Eye gore
- ◆
- ◆
- ◆

VEILS

A **Veil** is material that may exist but will remain off-screen, fade to black, or receive minimal description.

Veils:

- ◆
- ◆
- ◆
- ◆

ROMANCE AND SEXUAL CONTENT

Romance is allowed but restrained.

Affection normally appropriate in public company may be portrayed. Sexual or more intimate romantic activity will fade to black or remain off-screen. Explicit sexual roleplay is not permitted.

Erotic description, pornography, fetish material, graphic sexual discussion, and recurring sexual humor are outside the intended tone.

Romance involving a player character requires that player's consent. A player may decline, stop, or redirect romantic interaction without providing an in-character justification. This applies to both player characters and NPCs.

LANGUAGE

Profanity, vulgarity, crude sexual jokes, and similar crass language should be avoided or kept to a minimum, both in and out of character.

VIOLENCE AND HORROR

Combat, injury, death, dangerous labor, war, corporate violence, and threats to bodily autonomy are expected parts of the campaign.

Extreme cruelty, torture, mutilation, sadism, graphic gore, and similar material will not be celebrated or lingered on. Severe violence should be described only as much as the scene requires.

A player may ask for disturbing material to receive less description at any time.

SETTING CULTURES AND RELIGION

The Settled Systems contain fictional cultures, religions, ancestries, family structures, biological differences, and social customs that may differ substantially from ordinary human experience.

These elements should be portrayed according to the established setting without turning them into sexual content, running jokes, or out-of-character ideological arguments.

For example, Fonqugons are an agendered ancestry and should be portrayed accordingly.

Religion may be treated seriously. The campaign may portray sincere belief, doubt, corruption, false teaching, hypocrisy, and competing interpretations of revelation. The GM will not narrate what God thinks, wills, condemns, forgives, or judges.

PLAYER RESPONSIBILITIES

Players agree to:

- ◆ Create characters capable of functioning with the party.
- ◆ Give other players room to speak, roleplay, investigate, and make decisions.
- ◆ Avoid repeated interruption, talking over others, or dominating the table.
- ◆ Allow each player to make the final decisions for their own character.
- ◆ Avoid deciding another character's thoughts, emotions, beliefs, or relationships.
- ◆ Learn the core mechanics and frequently used abilities of their character.
- ◆ Ask questions when uncertain about the rules.
- ◆ Prepare for upcoming turns when reasonably possible.
- ◆ Respect the group's Lines, Veils, and other boundaries.
- ◆ Raise genuine problems clearly instead of expressing frustration through repeated grumbling, hostile jokes, sniping, or background commentary.

"That's what my character would do" does not override the responsibility to participate in a cooperative game.

ADVICE AND TACTICAL DISCUSSION

Players may offer advice when asked.

Brief unsolicited suggestions are acceptable unless the receiving player asks that they stop. Once the active player understands the relevant information and makes a decision, the table should move forward.

CONFLICT BETWEEN PLAYER CHARACTERS

Characters may argue, distrust, threaten, or oppose one another.

Significant actions against another player character require the affected player's agreement to make that kind of conflict part of the game. This includes mechanical PvP, stealing important possessions, deliberate sabotage, coercive mental effects, significant betrayal, or intentionally preventing another character from participating.

GAME MASTER RESPONSIBILITIES

The GM agrees to:

- ◆ Respect player agency over what characters voluntarily think, believe, say, attempt, and choose.
- ◆ Respond reasonably to unexpected player decisions.
- ◆ Make rules decisions in good faith and apply them consistently.
- ◆ Listen to concise corrections when something may have been overlooked.
- ◆ Provide information the characters would reasonably know when it is necessary to make a meaningful decision.
- ◆ Respect all established content boundaries.
- ◆ Make room for players who are being interrupted, spoken for, or crowded out.
- ◆ Apply the campaign's moral framework consistently.
- ◆ Never retaliate in-game for out-of-game criticism, disagreement, scheduling issues, or interpersonal conflict.

The GM may describe involuntary sensations, dreams, memories, instincts, or effects imposed by game mechanics. These do not determine a character's voluntary beliefs or choices unless a specific rule explicitly does so.

RULES AND TABLE PROCEDURE

Rules questions should normally be directed to the GM.

Another player may briefly provide a rule when the GM or active player asks for assistance.

The GM may make a provisional ruling to keep play moving. Extended disagreement should wait until a break or after the session. A provisional ruling may be corrected for future play.

When another player has a personal scene, major decision, or focused conversation, give that scene appropriate space.

COMMUNICATION AND PROBLEMS

Ask what someone meant before assuming their motives when practical.

If recurring behavior is interfering with your enjoyment of the game, address it before resentment accumulates. Focus on the specific behavior and its effect on play.

A player may speak directly with the person involved or ask the GM to help facilitate the conversation.

Players may also bring concerns to the GM privately. The GM will use appropriate discretion, but resolving recurring behavior may eventually require discussing it with the person involved.

If something must remain confidential, say so before sharing it. The GM will tell you whether that limitation can be accepted.

The GM will not create passive-aggressive rules, encounters, seating arrangements, or indirect punishments intended to secretly correct one player.

If someone has been told that a behavior is causing a problem and it repeatedly continues, the group should address it directly.

Participation in the campaign remains voluntary.

SESSION ETIQUETTE

During sessions, everyone agrees to:

- ◆ arrive prepared when reasonably possible;
- ◆ give notice when they expect to be late or absent;
- ◆ respect the agreed start and end times;
- ◆ avoid disruptive side conversations;
- ◆ keep unrelated phone or computer use from interfering with play;
- ◆ prepare for upcoming turns when possible;
- ◆ ask for breaks when needed and return within a reasonable time;
- ◆ avoid repeatedly derailing the session with unrelated conversation.

Real-life obligations take priority over the game. If attendance or scheduling becomes consistently incompatible with the campaign, the group will discuss it directly.

CHARACTER RETIREMENT AND LEAVING THE CAMPAIGN

A player may retire a character who no longer fits the campaign or is no longer enjoyable to play.

The GM may require retirement when a character:

- ◆ develops a sustained pattern of serious evil without meaningful course correction;
- ◆ can no longer reasonably cooperate with the party;
- ◆ repeatedly becomes a vehicle for violating table boundaries.

When practical, the player and GM should work together to give the character an appropriate conclusion.

Players may also leave the campaign. Nobody is obligated to continue participating indefinitely in a game they no longer enjoy or cannot reasonably attend.

TABLE AGREEMENT

By signing below, we agree to:

- ◆ respect the group's boundaries;
- ◆ give each player control over their own character;
- ◆ share the table;
- ◆ communicate when something is causing a problem;
- ◆ listen when another person raises a concern;
- ◆ address recurring problems directly and in good faith.

We understand that compatibility cannot always be created through rules alone.

Participation in **Erbium Industries** remains voluntary for both players and the Game Master.

SIGNATURES

GAME MASTER

Printed Name:

Signature: Date:

PLAYER

Printed Name:

Signature: Date:

PLAYER

Printed Name:

Signature: Date:

PLAYER

Printed Name:

Signature: Date:

PLAYER

Printed Name:

Signature: Date:

AMENDMENTS

Material changes to this agreement will be discussed with the group and recorded in the current version.